Kaden Grace

Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
Knoxville, TN 37919

E-mail: kaden.grace@utk.edu
Web: kadengrace.co
Updated: November 2026

Doctoral Studies

University of Tennessee – Knoxville
Ph.D., Economics — 2027 (expected)
M.A., Economics — 2024

Dissertation Committee and References:

Matt Harris (Chair)
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
E-mail: mharris@utk.edu

Seth Neller
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
E-mail: sneller@utk.edu

Christian Vossler
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
E-mail: cvossler@utk.edu

Jason Lindo
School of Economics
Georgia Institute of Technology
E-mail: jlindo@gatech.edu

Prior Education

University of Mississippi
B.S., Economics — May 2022
B.A., Mathematics — May 2022
Honors: *summa cum laude*, Phi Kappa Phi

Fields of Interest

Primary: Public Economics, Health Economics
Secondary: Labor Economics, Behavioral and Experimental Economics

Working Papers

"The Eyes of Texas are Upon OB/GYNs: Physician Migration and Crowd-sourced Enforcement of Abortion Policy" (*JMP*)
with Martin Andersen

Abstract: This paper studies the labor market effects of private liability enforcement using Texas Senate Bill 8 (SB-8, 2021) as a natural experiment. A private enforcement mechanism in this context allows any citizen to sue anyone who aids or abets a prohibited abortion for minimum damages of $10,000. This practice lowers the evidentiary burden and expands the pool of potentially liable individuals, which raises expected operating costs and could incentivize out-migration for a broad set of physicians compared to traditional state enforcement. We leverage variation across physician specialties, states, and time in a synthetic difference-in-differences (SDID) design to compare reproductive health physicians to all other physicians in Texas against similarly regulated states before and after SB-8's signing. We find that reproductive health physicians did not leave Texas at differential rates following SB-8. We can rule out an effect larger than 989 physicians moving, a 4.1% change relative to the pre-period baseline. For reference, we can rule out effects as large as those found in most of the contemporary literature on physician migration responses to state-enforced abortion restrictions. We also examine posted salaries and numbers of job offers and find no evidence of increased turnover nor compensating wage differentials under the risk

of private enforcement. Our results provide a contrast to prominent media narratives of a large OB/GYN exodus from Texas.

"Saving for a Rainy Day: Experimental Evidence on Prize-Linked Saving and Financial Shocks"
(*Under Review*)
Abstract: Liquidity constraints and inadequate precautionary savings create financial vulnerability for low-income households who face costly credit markets when unexpected expenses arise. This paper presents a laboratory experiment integrating a dynamic life-cycle savings model with prize-linked savings accounts (PLSAs, which offer lottery-style prizes in lieu of guaranteed interest) to investigate whether the behaviorally-motivated intervention can increase savings under financial uncertainty. I find that PLSAs crowd-out traditional savings accounts by 36.3 to 33.0 percent. Total savings do not increase. This portfolio reallocation imposes costs in the low prize treatment: participants earn 16.7 percent less than control, with the largest crowding-out effects concentrated among not risk averse individuals who exhibit 43.3 percent reductions in traditional savings. PLSAs function primarily as portfolio substitutes rather than savings-creation tools. Heterogeneity across risk preferences suggests that PLSAs should be marketed to unbanked households who are not risk averse.

"The Economic Impact of Unemployment Insurance Reform in Tennessee"
with Matt Harris, Larry Kessler, and Alex Norwood

Presentations

ISEO Summer School (Iseo, Italy), ASHEcon Annual Conference, Veritas Forum, Society of Government Economists Annual Conference, UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar (x2)	2026
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, ASHEcon Annual Conference, UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar	2025
UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar	2024
UTK Experiment and Theory Group Workshop, UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Graduate Student Research Seminar	2023
UTK Graduate Student Research Seminar	2022

Teaching

Pellissippi State Community College

Adjunct Instructor of Record

ECON 2200: Principles of Microeconomics	Spring 2027
ECON 2100: Principles of Macroeconomics (Syllabus)	Fall 2026

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

Instructor of Record

ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics (Syllabus, Evaluations)	Summer 2026
ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics (Syllabus, Evaluations)	Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

ECON 211: Principles of Microeconomics	Fall 2022 – Spring 2023
ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Spring 2023
ECON 581: Mathematical Methods in Economics	Fall 2023

Fellowships & Awards

Best Research Presenter, *UT Knoxville*	2026
Best Second-Year Thesis, *UT Knoxville*	2024
Best First-Year Graduate Student, *UT Knoxville*	2023
Walter Melville Bonham PhD Fellowship	2024
J. Fred & Wilma Holly PhD Fellowship	2024–2026
Joseph & Barbara O'Donnell PhD Fellowship	2023
Haslam Excellence Doctoral Fellowship	2022–2026

Research Experience

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

Research Assistant (Graduate) 2023–Current

Developed and curated a novel dataset of every physician and hospital in the U.S.: approximately 4.3M records per month across 19 years

Experimental Lab Manager 2023–Current

Led the design and execution of 27 experimental sessions with 1,100+ participants

Skills

Translate applied research into decision-ready insights for non-technical stakeholders

Causal Inference: A/B testing, randomized controlled trials (RCTs), differences-in-differences (DiD), instrumental variables (IV), regression discontinuity (RD)

Modeling & Machine Learning: machine learning (ML), generalized method of moments (GMM), generalized least squares (GLS), discrete choice modeling

Coding: Python, R, Stata, LaTeX, Excel, Git, Qualtrics, Generative AI/LLM tooling (Claude Code), robotic process automation (RPA), optical character recognition (OCR), Model Context Protocol (MCP) tool development

Affiliations

Member: Society of Government Economists, Southern Economic Association, American Society of Health Economists

Student Representative, Campus Advisory Board	2025–2026
Chairperson, Doctoral Student Association	2023–2024
Organizer, Graduate Student Research Seminar	2023–2025

Languages

English (native), French (fluent, B2)